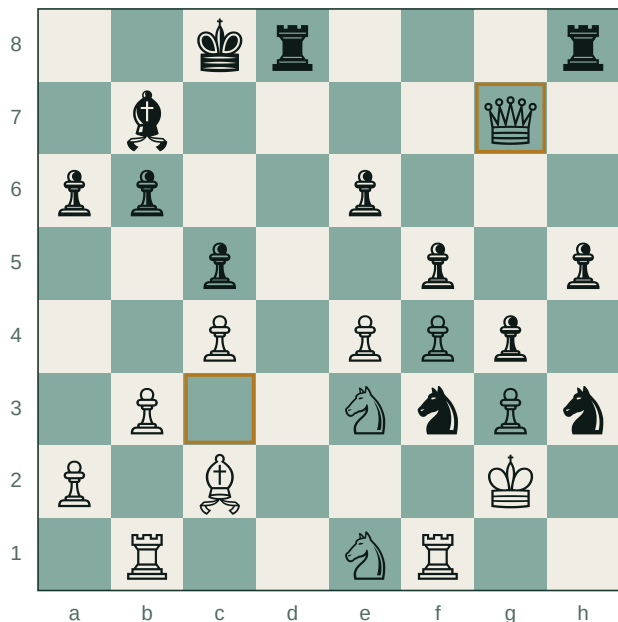


Arabian mating nets: Black, move 25

Arabian mating nets

Black to move



Previous move: 25.Qxg7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25...Rd2+ 26. Rf2 Rxf2+ 27. Kh1 Rh2#

25...Rd2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From d2 it attacks king on g2 and bishop on c2. Recorded reply: **26.Rf2**.

26...Rxf2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From f2 it attacks king on g2 and bishop on c2. Recorded reply: **27.Kh1**.

27...Rh2# Mate: rook on h2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A mating label describes a recurring arrangement, not a substitute for checking the exact legal defenses on this board.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

In an Arabian-type net a rook and knight cooperate near a corner. One piece gives check while the other protects the rook or controls escape squares.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for a cornered king, a rook entry, and a knight square that links protection with restriction.

The defending king is on g2. Geometrically undefended: queen on g7 and knight on e3. Check for tactical protection.